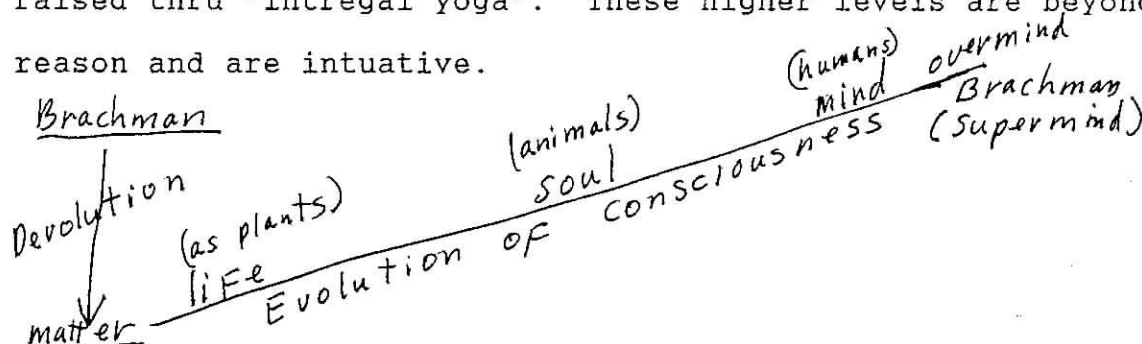


SRI AURUBINDO GHOSE (1872-1950)

He is very popular in the U.S., especially among those interested in Eastern Religions. For our purposes, his evolutionary view of life is important and I would not be at all surprized if A.C. Clark was very much aware of his philosophy.

For Aurubindo, matter is at the bottom of the evolutionary ladder, and Brachman, the absolute, is at the top. Right below Bracman is the Overmind, a place he believed we could reach while still alive. The reason for eveolution is that the Spirit (Brachman) is pushing it forward. It is an evolution of consciousness.

Humans are on the level of mind but can have consciousness raised thru "intregal yoga". These higher levels are beyond reason and are intuitive.



He has been compared to Tielhard de Chardin, the Jesuit who developed the idea of an Omaega point to which we are evolving.

There is no question that Clark was probably aware of Aurubindo and certainly Tielhard. Aurubindo was educated in England.

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CHILDHOOD'S END BY Arthur C. Clark, 1953

What appears to be several huge ships descend and sit over the world's major cities with the purpose of uniting the world and controlling it.

They bring security, peace and prosperity.

Most of the leaders of the world's religions sign a declaration of support for the rule of the overlords but it is not a unanimous opinion.

the main problem is the overlords allow no one to see them, even the UN sec. general who is the one communicating with them.

The overlords, as humans call them, tolerate all forms of govt. as long as it is not oppressive or corrupt.

After the sect. general is kidnapped and rescued by the head overlord, Kerallen, he decides to try to devise a way to see them since the main problem with people is this need.

He tries a plan with a flash gun but fails. However Kerellen tells him that in 50 years they will show themselves to humans.

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Part II, THE GOLDEN AGE

50 years have passed and the overlords reveal themselves to humans. It is also realized that there is only one ship, and Kerellen had used illusion to create what seemed like many others.

When he comes out of his ship, only a few people faint for he has leather wings, little horns, a barbed tail--ie the most terrible of all legends has come to life.

It seems in racial memory they had come into violent conflict with humans eons ago.

This was a completely secular age with only a form of purified Buddhism-the most austere of all religions- surviving.

The overlords had on film all the past 5000 years of human history and it became obvious they were not all right. Within a few days all humankinds multitudinous messiahs had lost their divinity.

The fall of religion was paralleled by a decline in science- it seemed futile to search for secrets the overlords had already uncovered. The end of strife and conflict of all kinds also meant the virtual end of creative art.

The overlords are very interested in human psychology and psychic phenomena. A party is held. Jan Rodricks, a young black student of physics and astronomy, witnesses an overlord ship going into space and feels angry that the overlords have shut the door on research into flight in space. He notes the direction of the ship into the constellation, carina.

After the party several people participate in a oijia board seance with an overlord watching. When it is finally Jan's turn he asks "What Star is the overlord's sun?" it answers: NGS 549672

One woman, Jean Morrel, faints. When the overlords discuss it they believe Jean is the most important person alive and must watch her and Jan.

Jan finally gets a chance to check the star charts and discovers that NGS 549672 was right in the heart of the

constellation carina. Thus he is the only one on Earth to know the origin of the overlords.

[use if time: There was so much leisure, work week about 20 hours and doing what one wanted to do. Education was needed to overcome boredom. The abolition of armies and defense budget had doubled the worlds effective wealth and increased production had done the rest. sports and entertainment were the largest industries. the question now was "where do we go from here?"]

Jan gets help from an oceanographer to build a self-contained capsual for him to stowaway in an overlord ship within the belly of a whale being shipped to their world.

It is 40 light years to their planet but they can go 99% of the speed of light so only 2 months would pass for him going each way while 80 years would pass on earth.

Jan puts himself in hibernation for most the trip. After he leaves, Kerellan announces that there had been a stowaway and it was Jan. He also says that there is no way he can stay there and in fact that humans cannot handle what they will find in space, thus the kaibash on space research. "the stars are not for man."

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part III: THE LAST GENERATION

10 years after Jan has stowed away, Jean Morrel and her now husband George with son Jeffrey move to an art colony called New Athens. It was a protest against the overlords but they did nothing to stop it. They practiced all the arts, drama, music, painting, writing, etc.

Thier son Jeffrey has a strange experience during an earthquake when a voice tells him to run up a hill or he will be drowned by a tidal wave. As he does he runs into a huge rock and the voice tells him to move it. He does so with his mind.

The overlords visit the colony and research Jeffrey. Jeff tells his dad that he thinks the overlord was the voice that helped him on the beach.

George realized theres more to it and they are being watched. Jeff, age 7, begins having dreams of a blue sun with a sulphur mountain. the overlords take notice.

he continues to dream every night, going further out into space each time. Finally he dreams of a place outside the galaxy so the overlords know it won't be much longer.

They visit the family again and George knows Jeff must be seeing something real in his dreams. The overlords verify it.

his little sister, Jenny, begins the same path tho she is just a baby. she progresses much more quickly. The overlords call this TOTAL BREAKTHROUGH.

The overlords were simply the midwives who helped bring about this breakthrough, tho they themselves could not use any psychic power. They are caught in an evolutionary cul de sac. A race without a future.

Jeffrey got to where he no longer went to school and his dreams were not separate from waking existence.

Jenny, tho a baby, had huge power, could remove food from the refrigerator and feed herself and in fact take care of all her own needs.

this metamorphosis infected the entire human race. It touched no one over 10 and under 10, no one escaped. Humanity lost its future, its children.

Kerallen makes his last speech to humans explaining that w/o thier guardianship, the human race would have destroyed itself and other races unknown to them. Above all is the OVERMIND using both the overlords and humans like a potter uses clay.

The overmind is trying to grow and extend its powers and awareness of the universe. It is the sum of many races but long ago left the tyranny of matter behind. It is conscious of intelligence everywhere.

When the time is right the overmind triggers this transformation in a child where it then explodes and spreads to all children.

Kerallen needs to evacuate all those transformed to protect them from homicide, even by parents who don't understand what is happening. All the rest must simply live out their lives till they die.

Jan comes home after spending 2 months with the overlords which he discovered was dedicated to studying alien cultures like a huge museum.

As they approach earth Jan realizes there is no light from cities or anything else. Kerallen greets him an arrival.

Jan is shown what has happened to the children progressively thru the years. They don't sleep, or eat, or wear clothes or

need food. They spent a few years in a strange dance and then stood still for lyears, never moving, oblivious to the seasons or night or day. They are tied into the overmind.

Jan realized athat the road to the stars was forked in two directions, neither led to a goal that included human hopes or fears.

At the end of one road were the overlords who preserved their individuality, independent egos, emotions, but were trapped. Their minds were much more powerful than humans but they were helpless and equally overwhelmed by the universe.

At the other end lay the Overmind, whatever it might be, bearing the same relation to man as man has to the amoeba. Potentially infinite, beyond mortality, it was absorbing race after race as it spread across the stars.

The overlords have been the tools of the overmind and Earth is the 5th race to be guided to transformation.

Jan is told that because of the fact time is non linear the future and past are one. so thousnads of years ago humans glimpsed the overlords dimly and associated them with the end of humankind causing terror of thier form and stories of Satan to arise.

Jan is literally the last man on earth since the rest had died out 10 years before his arrival. For about 6 years he lives his life especially playing Bach and filling his house with music to keep away lonliness.

One day he notices the moon has begun to turn on its axis and realizes the children are emerging from their long trance.

the overlords realize they must now leave but Jan decides to remain having realized that space is not for man. The overlords ask him to stay and keep reporting as long as possible what their instruments are reading.

He reports a great burning column over the western horizon, they are on their way to become part of the Overmind and leaving the last remnants of matter behind.

he sees what he thinks must be the overmind in colors and shapes, like the aurora borealis only more so. tremendous energy

He notices his weight decreasing along with gravity. sees things rising into the air till anything not attached to Earth is going up, including the atmosphere. He feels an emotion of fulfillment and achievement.

Jan's last report: "Everything we ever achieved is gone up there into the stars. Perhaps that's what the old religions were trying to say but they got it all wrong: They thought mankind was so important, yet we're only one race in - do you know how many? Yet now we've become something that you could never be."

then the Earth explodes leaving nothing as it feeds its energy to the transformed children.

Kerellans mission is over but he feels sad that his race can't follow the same evolution. they serve the overmind because they have no choice but even in that service they would not lose their souls.

End of review

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This is a much more positive view of the destiny of humans than most books dealing with the end of things. Clark is not a religious person but it is interesting that he sees human destiny much in the same way as some known mystics, such as we discussed.

Both Aurubindo and de Chardin believed humans are evolving in a spiritual manner. Much of the new age religions share this optimism.

ques: (1) Is this realistic? or is this really just wishful thinking?

2) Without help, or guardianship, such as the Overlords provided would humans be able to evolve, or would we blow ourselves to bits as much apocalyptic sf predicts?

③ He calls the overlords a cul de sac in evolution, ie, they can never evolve beyond where they are. Is it possible there are sentient races in the galaxy who cannot evolve spiritually?

④ Or by definition does being sentient mean one has a spiritual evolution?

~~Show clips from ~~1985~~ - @ 20 min 1985
 Discuss idea of an AI that can bond and love
 Discuss - there are no more humans
 miracle mile - 1989~~

Time Machine - 1960
 show clips - @ 20-25 min
 people still of 1st in 80, 2002 -
 mutants (mole people) live underground
 people (eloi) live above but like cattle
 Scenes 12-15 - 10 min
 Scene 17, 5 min - can skip
 Scene 20 - 4 min

#14 SUMMARY OF THEOLOGY IN TIME AND SPACE

This course has attempted to show how religion or religious ideas are present in much of science fiction, even if the story is not specifically about religion.

Defining religion in the broadest sense, we dealt with ideas of How religion develops, ethics, what makes a being sentient, pseudo religion, concepts of a messiah figure, and apocalyptic, or the end of the universe or the world.

There are several things which I observed as I wrote this course that were new insights to me.

First, and probably the most obvious, is the fact that we are basically trapped in certain ways of viewing religion such that we project onto other planets and species religions similar to what we have here on Earth. In other words, it seems we are really not able to perceive something completely alien. In other words we can't escape our own symbol system.

Second, it seems in the area of ethics that we are better able to visualize different understandings than we are in the concept of God. However, this is variations on a theme, such as in "Half a life" when 60 was decided as the age of resolution. This was to prevent people from living beyond their usefulness and is a problem currently being dealt with here.

third, there were some creative ways of dealing with apocalyptic. Most of the stories dealing with the end of the world were typically post atomic bomb and thus saw the world ending in an atomic nightmare. Even Canticle for Liebowitz, tho projecting it to the year 3780 or so, believed that would be the

C
eventual end of the World. The second favorite end seems to be an astroid or something, hitting the Earth.

Of course, and we didn't deal with this as it is technically not science fiction, many books see the end as the coming of Satan, or one like him and the biblical end with the four horsemen of the apocalypse.

I feel that Arthur C. Clarks stories had some of the most creative ideas in this area. The "Nine Billion Names of God" and Childhood's end both by him, had some great ideas. Particularly Childhood's End by seeing our evolution into something beyond the material followed the religious ideas of Tielhard De Chardin and Sri Aurobindo Ghose, both very popular today. In fact, more popular today than when the book was written in 1953.

fourth, In dealing with the ideas of a Messianic figure some books are better than others. Dune is dealing with a mahdi as the "man on the white horse" so to speak. Paul Maud dib is a catalyst for the Freman. However, the Jihad started by them is out of his control so in this sense he is not their leader.

In Lord of Light, we have a buddhist vs hindu vs. Christian with Sam, the buddhist, winning out and being recognized as the messiah. This of course, reflects the writers own prejudice, I believe, but also the reality in India.

It is with Stranger in a Strange Land that we have the most influential book dealing with a messiah figure. This book touched a cord far beyond the sci fi genre. Its timing, message of trustworthy communication and honesty met a cultural need.

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CONCLUSIONS;

Science fiction that lasts and is really popular is not just stories in space with high tech weaponry and gadgetry. That part is fun and helps the story but what really makes some sci fi popular, I believe, is it touches a sociological and religious need or desire in the culture of its time.

For example, the most obvious examples are Star Wars and Star Trek. What is it that makes them so great? Basically Star Trek was not afraid to take on ethical and social problems and foresee a future in which we would not end ourselves in an atomic holocaust but rather solve our problems and have real peace and prosperity. The Alien races in Star Trek and in science fiction are reminiscent of the gods, angels, demons and fairies of legend and are often gifted with supernatural powers and abilities.

This is true for Star Wars as well. The mystical elements are very overt in this classic story of good winning over evil. The Force, like the Tao of chinese religion, permeates everything. The son who saves the father is among other great themes of mythology.

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It is interesting to note that in the late 40's and 50s the culture was basically optimistic, we had the bomb and were invincible. However, science fiction from this era was basically pessimistic, seeing a horrible end because of the bomb.

In the 60's, 70's and 80's, science fiction became more optimistic, Dune, Stranger, Star Trek and Star Wars, etc. while the society as a whole became more pessimistic. It is almost

like science fiction is a mirror reflecting religious and cultural needs of each era.

For some people, science fiction fandom is meeting a religious need. In Gnosis magazine for the summer of 1994, it points out that for many people traditional religion is no longer meeting a need but by projecting onto the future the sacred is not lost, it is honored in new forms which the theologians and philosophers don't recognize yet as holy. The eternal return of the past has given way to an aspiration toward the future onto which we project the same ideals that inspired traditional religion.

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Scientology, founded by SF writer L. Ron Hubbard, has not had good press is a good example of a religion combined with SF. It involves initiations that start as an alternative form of psychotherapy and go on to recover "memories" of ancient galactic intrigues from earlier incarnations. Again, the mythic past is reinterpreted in futuristic terms.

There are UFO sects such as Unarius, that are plainly religious and resemble secret societies in inverse. They know the secrets of the spiritually advanced aliens. These groups received a boost from "Close Encounters of the Third Kind".

There is still a group based on Heinleins "Stranger in a Strange Land" called the Church of all worlds. It is an expression of post hippie paganism with a large membership drawn from myriad witchcraft traditions as well as SF fandom. There "nests" practice ritual magic and "polyamory" and they publish a

magazine called "Green Egg". Unlike UFO cults and scientology, the Church of all worlds knows they are based on a work of fiction. They treat Heinleins' novel as an expression of important ideas, not as prophecy of a coming Martian Messiah.

Thus, if communism, facism, and other secular movements are in a sense "religions", then so is fandom, with its holy books, infallible prophets, and antagonism towrds noninitiates. The shamanic initiations of the past replaced bones and tissue with crystal; now the android, or cyborg fulfills the same transhuman role.

LORD OF LIGHT by Roger Zelazny, 1967. Hugo and Nebulae award
His Followers called him Mahasamatman and said he was a god. He
preferred to drop the Maha and the atman, however and called
himself Sam. He never claimed to be a god. But then, he never
claimed not to be. . .

This novel takes place long after the death of Earth, on a
planet settled by human colonists. There, the original settlers
have recreated the ancient Hindu pantheon, bestowing upon
themselves--by means of mutation and the technology which they
deny all others on the planet--godlike powers and godlike
immortality. They rule their world with godlike arrogance and
caprice.

Each god has his or her own aspect and attributes, the gods
rule: Brahma, the creator; Shiva, Lord of Chaos; Kali, goddess of
destruction; Yama, Lord of Death; Krishna, Lord of Lust, and all
others constructed from memories of ancient Earth and its
theologies.

Sam alone opposes them, one of the few who rejected the
prerequisites of godhood, believing that the ordinary mortals
should be freed from the tyranny of their self-appointed deities.
He has many names including Siddhartha, binder of kDemons, the
enlightened one, Buddha and Kalkin, the one who comes at the end
of time to make all things right. His Atman, or soul, had been
sent into the magnetic belt called the bridge of the gods where
he has been for some 50 years out of the way. Now he is brought
back by those who have kept the flames of revolution alight. He
alone can lead the battle against the gods once more.

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SYNOPSIS:

I. Ratri, goddess of night, sends high frequency prayers into the magnetic cloud from a prayer machine built by Yama, Lord of Death. Ratri speaks to Tak, a person incarnated in an ape, saying that Sam is thier only hope against Heaven. Sam comes back but is not happy having his peace that passes understanding disturbed. It takes him a long time to recover and face the world again.

Ratri can do this because the gods have developed a way of using bodies to reincarnte into when they get old. They hide him in Ratri's temple till he's ready to lead.

The RAKASA are the original inhabitants of the planet and are creatures of energy rather than matter. They once had bodies but found a way to live in stabel fields of energy. The arrival of the humans stirred them to cause problems. It was Sam 50 years before who found a way to bind them in a plsce called Hellwell. Gambling is their weakness and a human body the highest inducement any demon (as the humans called them) could be offered.

A monk, Aram, arrives at the temple asking if a new teacher had arisn in the vicinity. Yama arrives and knows Aram for who he is, Mara, Lord of Darkness. Yama kills him. They have to invent a story to explain Mara's death so they get Sam to finally speak to thre monks there since they were upset over the death. This is because they practice Ahimsa or non-injury of any living thing. Sam preaches to them saying what they have witnessed is of as high order. Dwell only on the nameless and on beauty.

II. Sam rides into the capital and searches for another first one named Jan Olvagga, at this time a sailor. Jan tells him that the old religion is not only THE religion, it is the revealed, enforced, and frightenly demonstratable religion. He tells Sam that @ 12 years ago psych probes began being used on those up for renewal, ie, to get a new body. the Masters of Karma use it to insure the caste system and diecratic control.

The definition of bad karma is anything our friends, the gods, don't like. A person comes at age 60 to the clinic of the god of the church of his choice and it is decided what caste he/she will enter, what age, sex, and health of body one will recieve. Sam tells him he hopes to oppose the gods and asks if they are omnipotent. Jan says he hopes not but fears the day is not far off.

Sam speaks to Brahma who explains that the common people are not ready for accelertion into the industrial age as it would destroy the first stable society on the planet. Sam recognizes Brahma as a woman he knew, which irritates Brahma. He also comments that they did not allow the printing press to be "invented" but allowed a still to be.

Sam decides to get a new body and thought Brahma had dealt faiarly with him till the young man whose body he would have fell down in a epileptic fit. He confronts the masters of Karma, have a fight and Sam destroys that temple and the masters and moves on to capture heavens gate.

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III. Kali dispatched her holy executioner, Rild, to kill him near the village of Albuldil to kill Sam. There is a temple of Kali facing a temple of Yama which attracts many pilgrims. Sam is settled outside the village teaching the eightfold path of the Buddha to his followers. The Brahmin priests didn't like this heretic in their midst but it filled their coffers so they tolerated him. Kali disagreed and tries to have him killed.

His executioner got sick on the way and Sam nurses him back to health. He remains with Sam and becomes a Buddhist monk. Yama, angry because of Rild's betrayal of Kali, comes to fight him. After a long battle, Yama is triumphant and then goes after Sam.

The four regents of the world arrive and say Yama can't have Sam. Yama says he is god of death and can take whomever he likes. The regents say they dispute this one for in his hands he holds the destiny of our world. Yama can have him only after overthrowing the four powers. Yama defeats the regents, but the trees and grass hold him so he can't touch Sam. All this time Sam is sitting meditating as if nothing is going on.

Sam tells Yama that he already slew the Buddha, Rild, who had attained enlightenment. Sam has not but heaven, Yama tells him, has decided he must be killed anyway. They, the gods, must do it or he will be a martyr and his religion will grow. It has to be the gods so the people know which religion is really the stronger: Buddhism or Hinduism. He must die the real death, ie not be given another body.

Yama tries to talk Sam into giving up his crusade and become one of the gods. Ssm says no and makes a dig at Kali which infuriates Yama, who loves her. Yama lunges for Sam but is caught in quicksand. Sam says if it wasn't for Kali, he would not have lowered himself so. He informs Yama^{he} his leaving to continue his fight and if he yells for help his monks will come rescue him. He picks up his stuff and heads for Hellwell.

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IV. The gods left a sign on Hellwell warning people not to enter as the Rakasa were imprisoned there. Sam knows the code to open the door and does so and begins his descent. He heres cries of "free me master" voices begging him to let them go. Sam reaches the bottom and speaks to Taraka, the head of the Rakasa. Sam tells him he had to be captured in order to save his own species, humanity. Taraka says: "you stole our world, Siddhartha. What new indignity would you lay upon us?

Sam says he will free them if they will be allies and help lay seige to the city of the gods. Sam sets Taraka free to go spy out the city. The rest are angry at not being released but Sam says he is there one chance for freedom so be quiet. they are

Taraka comes back and reports that his kind can enter and disarm the ~~along and the~~ guards. Sam says he can go home and raise an army and that his new religion moves across the land so the gods are not as great as they once were in human eyes.

Sam frees 65 Rakasa but while he sleeps Taraka takes over his body. He says he will keep his promise but wants to experience pleasure first. Sam argues that they will lose the

element of surprise if they don't act quickly but Taraka says he has intertwined Sam's body and can take on Yama. Sam is skeptical but can't control Taraka till he regains strength. He fails to overcome Taraka, who has recalled his 65 rakasa and have taken over most the people in his castle.

Finally, Taraka grows weary of this life of lust and Sam tells him that is the human condition, guilt. This is the curse of the Buddha.

Agni, god of fire, comes and against Sam's better judgement, Taraka fights him and Sam's palace is destroyed. Taraka/Sam fly away to Hellwell where Taraka frees the rest of the Rakasa as they sing about the day they will rise again and destroy man.

Four gods are coming after them and Sam warns that they can't stand against them all. Taraka wants to test them so he sends some of his Rakasa against them while he and Sam bide their time and await word of the battle. After a long wait Sam/Taraka decide to steal the thunder chariot of Shiva. They make it to the chariot but can't get away before Agni arrives. The gods capture Sam and Taraka leaves his body.

Sam awakes in chains. He expected to be killed but Yama is taking him to see Brahma. Yama says to Sam: "Being a god is the quality of being able to be yourself to such an extent that your passions correspond with the forces of the universe. Being a god is being able to recognize within oneself these things that are important and then to strike the single note that brings them into alignment with everything else that exists."

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V. Kali and Sam discuss the old days when they were among the first and loved each other. Samn says to love Yama and forget the past. He says he still cares for her but they would be at each others throat once there enemies were vanquished. For are not worship and religious awe a combination of love and hate, desire and fear?"

The gods discuss what to do with Sam. Kill him, try to alter his mind so he will accept the gods.

Sam goes to Helba, god/goddess (she alternates) of thieves to ask her to steal a belt of shells that also has micro-circitry in it. She agrees to try. They get the belt and it gives Sam power to fight the gods. It can unbind locks, warm him against the cold, and transport him anywhere in the world.

As Sam wandered the streets of the city, an ancient Jackbird circles and lands on his shoulder saying: Are you not Maitreya, Lord of Light, for whom the world has waited lo these may years. He whose coming I prophesied in as poem long ago?" Sam says no but the bird, once a poet, insists he is.

Yama and Kali get married with a wedding feast that lasts for seven days. The Rakasa cannot break into the city because of the force field around it, tho they try. After this a purge takes place in the celestial city and many gods are exiled into the world. Varuna, the Just, leaves on his own as he can't stand the debauchrey. Sam is killed by Kali but he has learned from Taraka how to leave his body and he finds another one.

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VI. Brahma is found dead by Ratri. The other gods are called in and debate who should take his place as heaven should never be without a Brahma, ie creator. They decide Kali would be the best replacement, tho she will have to become male. Since she was scorned by Sam she will carry on the fight against him and the humans who are accelerationists, ie want scientific progress.

Yama and Kali arrive back at heaven and she is told they want her. Yama is not happy @ it as it means the end of their marriage. He wanders away and when he returns in the morning finds that Shiva has also been killed. Still no suspects. Agni will replace Shiva.

Only a few gods know of these deaths as they are kept secret. However, Ratri is afraid Yama will blame her since she found Brahma dead. She's glad hes dead but didn't do it. Yama uses a psych probe on all 37 suspects including Ratri, but finds none guilty.

Meanwhile the flush toilet and printing press are rediscovered in one village. Thus Brahma (Kali) decides it is time to move against the accelerationists. Kubera, another diety, finds Sam and realizes he is the one who is killing the gods so people can start living with technology without the fear of the wrath of Heaven. Sam has a new body but also the ability to beat the psych probe. He had been probed by Yama and found innocent and in fact, Yama didn't recognize him at all.

Kubera and Sam fight and Sam loses. He carries him to the pens and straps him to the kGaruda bird. Ratri joins them. They fly away and both begin drilling their troops. Sam those that

will fight the gods and Kubera those who will fight Sam and his minions.

Taraka and the legions of the Rakasa join Sam one evening keeping their promise to help. Takara has also recruited others who hate the gods. Yama comes and offers himself to help Sam, not because he is an accelerationist but because he has lost Kali, who is now a male, Brahma. He will fight with Sam but with the understanding he will not fight Brahma.

Sam has recruited Nirriti, the black one, who controls the soulless ones, or zombies. Yama is not happy about that but Sam says he is desperate for help. The battle is joined the next morning and Nirriti's troops of zombies and the Rakasa hold the field but realize the gods are watching and judging their strength.

Sam puts on his talisman belt and with Yama as his charioteer they charge into the battle with the gods. Mara, lord of darkness, recognizes the belt on Sam and realizes he is also Kalkin, the god who would come at the end of time (the yuga) to make things right and bring justice.

After the battle, only Brahma, Mara and two demigods remain. Ratri is banished from the city and condemned to be given only middle aged, plain bodies from then on. Yama was found dead in his cell, suicide it was believed. Sam's Atman was sent via a radio tower up into the magnetic cloud that circles the planet again. But the Rakasa are now free and Nirriti, god of the undead is also.

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VII. After the battle, much scientific progress is being made and the gods are weakend and not trying to stop it. So Sam is winning after all. Nirriti and Jan Olegg, the sailor known by Sam and one of the first, discuss the situation. Jan says he is a Christian. Nirriti wants Jan to help him make the city of the gods fall. Jan says he will help as the tdrue faith must come again soon. Taraka of the Rakasa decides to help destroy the celestial city also.

Fifty years have passed and Sam and Yama discuss their returning power and the fact that the gods are weakened as humans become stronger. Kubera is leaking scientific knowledge into the world. Even Krishna is joining them. None of them want to be owing Nirriti anything so they discuss letting him attack the city of the gods and then Sam and Yama will kill the winners.

Nirriti attacks city after city. Brahman and Genesha, the elephant headed son of Shiva, discuss the fact he is a madman. He cares only for the souls in the cities, not the bodies. He wants to destroy every symbol of the religion of the gods. If he has to, he will send missionaries.

Sam is back in Ratri's palace and he calls for Taraka. Taraka is surprized to see him but Sam says Yama fetched him back. Sam sends a message via Taraka to Nirriti: the message is that they, Yama, Krishna, Kubera and Sam will ride to battle with him against the gods, bringing all their supporters, powers, and machineries to bear upon them if he will agree not to war against the followers of either Buddhism or Hinduism as they exist in the world for purposes of converting them to his persuasion.